



The Register Reply

One question on the board, and when you call a student's name they answer it instead of saying "here". It takes about as long as the register already takes, and it gets every student used to saying something out loud in front of the room. This is Volume One.

Before you start. Say on the first morning that "here" is always a fine answer, so that nobody is put on the spot. The questions are about the day ahead and the things students like. If an answer tells you something you were not expecting, pick it up quietly afterwards rather than in front of the form. On a morning when something has happened in the form, skip the question and take the register the usual way.

What you need

Page	What it is	How many
Slides	How it works, then the five questions, one to a slide (a separate download)	Nothing to print

How it works

Step	What happens	Slides
1	Put the morning's question on the board before the students come in.	1 to 6
2	Answer it yourself first, in a few words. That sets the length, and it means nobody has to go first.	
3	Take the register as normal. Instead of saying "here", each student answers the question in a word or two. If one is worth coming back to, come back to it at the end.	
4	When the ten are used up, the last slide asks students to bring you a question of their own.	7

Worth knowing

- It works because it is short. A form of thirty answering in three or four words each still fits inside the time the register takes, and it gets quicker after the first week.
- The students who never volunteer anything in a lesson are the reason to do it. One word out loud in front of the room is a much smaller ask, and after a few weeks it stops being an ask at all.

Five more questions

1. Name a song you would put on right now.
2. Something that made you laugh this week.
3. Name one small thing you are grateful for this morning.
4. What is one thing you would like to learn this year?
5. Name one thing you will do today that nobody will notice.

Make sure you come back for Volume Two. Follow @thepastoralguide to hear when it lands.

